

## India fast emerging as a global manufacturing hub: PM Modi

India is fast emerging as a global manufacturing hub, having already become the world's second largest cellphone producer, Prime Minister Narendra Modi said at the inauguration of Samsung's largest cellphone manufacturing plant in the world in Noida, Uttar Pradesh. He added that, Samsung's launch of this manufacturing facility under Make in India initiative is not just an economic policy measure, but also a resolve for

better ties with friendly nations such as South Korea.

Set up at an investment of nearly ₹ 50 billion, Samsung's plant in Noida will increase the Korean handset maker's production capacity in India to 120 million annually, from 68 million.

Other global phone manufacturers such as Samsung and Apple, besides Chinese companies like Xiaomi, Oppo, Vivo and Huawei, are targeting India, which has more than a billion subscribers.

These companies are turning to local manufacturing because the government imposed a 10 per cent duty on imports of some key components.

PM Modi also said that, India is moving towards a digital revolution with a steep fall in data charges and fibre-optic networks reaching more than 100,000 villages. Cheaper cellphones, high-speed Internet and cheap data are ensuring fast and transparent service delivery.

## 137 companies eye ISRO's EV battery technology

To speed up the process of technology transfer for its electric vehicle (EV) batteries, Indian Space Research Organisation's (ISRO's) Vikram Sarabhai Space Centre (VSSC) in Thiruvananthapuram organised a pre-application conference for 137 companies that showed interest in its indigenously developed high-powered lithium-ion batteries, reported *Times of India*.

ISRO chairman K. Sivan said, "To familiarise the companies with the technology, representatives were shown the facility, where EV batteries were developed." Later, a documentary showing the development process of batteries was screened.

He added, "If these companies show confidence in taking up the task of mass production of EV batteries, they will be asked to submit required

documents along with an application and ₹ 400,000 as security deposit. There will be a three-stage evaluation process. A high-level committee, including government representatives, will be set up to scrutinise genuine contenders. If any company backs out during the evaluation process or is not shortlisted, ISRO will return the security deposit. Shortlisted companies will then be asked to pay a one-time fee of ₹ 10 million for technology transfer."

Sivan also clarified that foreign companies will not be given the technology and the patent will remain with ISRO. VSSC will transfer the technology to the shortlisted firms and help them produce cells of varying size, capacity, energy and power density, catering to the entire spectrum of power storage requirements.

## BEL signs MoU with Saab, Sweden

Navratna Defence PSU Bharat Electronics Ltd (BEL) has signed a memorandum of understanding (MoU) with Saab, Sweden, for jointly marketing L-band 3D air surveillance

radar, RAWL-03, co-developed by BEL and Saab.

BEL and Saab, Sweden and USA, will market the long-range air surveillance radar, a cost-effective L-band 3D

## On The Move

### Airtel names Ajay Chitkara as director, CEO of Airtel Business

Bharti Airtel has named Ajay Chitkara as director and chief executive officer (CEO) of Airtel Business. He replaces Ashok Ganapathy, who recently quit the company. Chitkara will run Airtel's local enterprise operations comprising services to corporates, governments, small and medium businesses, among others.

### Sangita Singh joins IBM Global Business Services

Sangita Singh, former Infosys executive vice president, has joined American IT services major IBM. She will be responsible for helping IBM's clients boost their cloud computing journey and forge greater ties with the global industry.

### Anchor Electricals appoints Vivek Sharma as MD

Anchor Electricals, a wholly-owned subsidiary of Japan's Panasonic Corp., has appointed Vivek Sharma as managing director (MD). In this role, Sharma will be responsible for driving the electricals arm of the organisation and oversee growth of all businesses comprising wiring devices, switchgears, wires, cables and tapes, conduit pipes, lighting, solar, power tools and indoor air quality.